

# GlowMart

## How to Choose and Wear Fragrance

### Fragrance Families

Fragrances are organized into families based on their dominant scent characteristics. Floral fragrances feature rose, jasmine, lily, and peony, and are the most popular family for everyday wear, ranging from light and fresh to rich and opulent. Woody fragrances include sandalwood, cedar, vetiver, and patchouli, creating warm, grounding scents that work beautifully in cooler weather and evening settings. Fresh fragrances feature citrus (bergamot, lemon, grapefruit), green (basil, mint), and aquatic (sea salt, ocean breeze) notes for a clean, energizing feel perfect for daytime and warm weather. Oriental fragrances combine vanilla, amber, musk, and spice (cinnamon, cardamom) for a rich, sensual experience ideal for evening wear and special occasions. Gourmand fragrances feature edible notes like chocolate, caramel, and coffee, creating cozy, comforting scents. Many modern fragrances blend multiple families.

### Concentration Levels

The concentration of fragrance oils determines how strong the scent is and how long it lasts on your skin. Eau de Parfum (EDP) has 15-20 percent concentration and lasts 6-8 hours, making it ideal for all-day wear and the best value for most customers. Eau de Toilette (EDT) has 5-15 percent concentration and lasts 3-5 hours, perfect for daytime, office wear, or when you want a lighter presence. Eau de Cologne (EDC) has 2-4 percent concentration and lasts 1-2 hours, often used as a refreshing splash. Body mists and sprays have 1-3 percent concentration and are great for a light scent refresh throughout the day, especially after workouts or between meetings. Parfum or Extrait de Parfum has 20-30 percent concentration and lasts 8-12 hours; it is the most concentrated and expensive option. GlowMart carries all concentration levels plus rollerballs (typically EDP concentration) for convenient travel and purse application.

### Understanding Scent Notes

Fragrances unfold in three stages called notes. Top notes are the first impression, lasting 15-30 minutes after application. They are typically light and volatile: citrus, light fruits, and herbs. Middle notes (heart notes) emerge as top notes fade, lasting 2-4 hours. They form the core character of the fragrance: florals, spices, and green notes. Base notes are the foundation, lasting 4-8 hours or longer. They are deep and rich: woods, musk, vanilla, and amber. When testing a fragrance, spray it and wait at least 30 minutes before deciding, as the top notes (which you smell first) are very different from the heart and base notes that you will actually wear all day. This is why a fragrance can smell completely different at the store versus several hours later.

### How to Apply Fragrance

Apply fragrance to pulse points where blood vessels are close to the skin, which generates warmth and helps project the scent: inner wrists, sides of the neck, behind ears, inside elbows, and behind knees. Do not rub your wrists together after spraying, as this friction generates heat that breaks down the top notes and alters the fragrance development. For longer-lasting fragrance, apply unscented moisturizer or petroleum jelly to pulse points before spraying, as hydrated skin holds fragrance better than dry skin. Spray from 6-8 inches

away for even distribution. For a subtle effect, spray into the air and walk through the mist. For hair fragrance, spray onto a brush and run through your hair rather than spraying directly (alcohol can dry hair). Avoid spraying fragrance on clothing as it can stain fabrics and does not develop the same way as on skin.

## **Fragrance Layering**

Layering different scented products can enhance longevity and complexity. Start with a scented body wash or shower gel as a base layer in the shower. Follow with a matching or complementary body lotion on damp skin. Apply your chosen fragrance to pulse points over the moisturized skin. GlowMart offers layering rollerball sets designed to be mixed and matched. When layering, choose products within the same fragrance family for a cohesive scent, or experiment with complementary families: florals with woods, citrus with vanilla, fresh with spicy. Many GlowMart fragrance brands offer matching body lotion and shower gel sets specifically designed for layering.

## **Choosing for the Season**

Lighter, fresh fragrances work best in spring and summer when heat intensifies scent projection. Citrus, aquatic, and light floral fragrances are ideal for warm weather. In fall and winter, cooler temperatures mute projection, so richer, warmer fragrances with woody, oriental, and gourmand notes come alive. Consider having a seasonal rotation of 2-4 fragrances. For office and professional settings year-round, choose moderate-sillage fragrances that stay close to the body. For evening events and date nights, bolder fragrances with greater projection are appropriate. Our beauty advisors can help you build a seasonal fragrance wardrobe from our collection of perfumes, colognes, body mists, and rollerballs.

## **Fragrance Storage and Care**

Proper storage extends the life of your fragrance from 3-5 years to potentially 10 years or more. Store fragrances upright in a cool, dark, dry place away from direct sunlight and temperature fluctuations. The bathroom is the worst place to store fragrance due to humidity and heat. A bedroom dresser drawer or closet shelf is ideal. Keep the cap on to prevent oxidation. Do not transfer fragrance to another container as exposure to air degrades the formula. If your fragrance changes color (darkening significantly), develops an off smell (sour or vinegar-like), or the top notes disappear leaving only base notes, it has likely expired and should be replaced.

## **Fragrance for Gifting**

Fragrance makes a thoughtful gift, but choosing for someone else can be tricky. GlowMart gift sets include a variety of mini sizes (typically 4-6 scents at 5-10ml each) so the recipient can discover their favorite. Our travel rollerball sets are also excellent gifts at an accessible price point of \$25-40. Discovery sets organized by fragrance family let the recipient explore an entire scent category. If unsure, a GlowMart gift card lets them choose their own scent with the help of our in-store fragrance advisors. For the fragrance enthusiast who already has a collection, consider a premium candle or room diffuser in their favorite scent family as an unexpected complement to their personal fragrance.